

DANIEL MORRIS

PH.D. CANDIDATE IN COGNITIVE NEUROSCIENCE

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ORCID | ResearchGate

Education

Ph.D. in Psychology

2022–Present

Northwestern University

Specialization in Cognitive Neuroscience

Advisor: Ken A. Paller | Expected completion: 2028

B.A. in Neuroscience

2016–2020

Middlebury College

Advisor: Jason Arndt

Publications

Morris, D. J., Torres-Platas, S. G., Konkoly, K. R., Hirschle, J., Sangpo, L., Thabkhe, Legden, T., Pelmo, L., Pasang, T., Grabowecky, M., Nusslock, R., & Paller, K. A. Inducing lucid dreaming based on a contemplative practice of compassion. *Brain Sciences*, 16(3). <https://doi.org/10.3390/brainsci16030315> 2026

Konkoly, K. R., **Morris, D. J.**, Hurka, K., Sanders, K., & Paller, K. A. Experimentally provoking dreams of unsolved puzzles during REM sleep boosts creative problem solving. *Neuroscience of Consciousness*, 2026(1), niaf067. <https://doi.org/10.1093/nc/niaf067> 2026

Konkoly, K. R., Al-Youssef, S., Mazurek, C., Mallett, R., **Morris, D. J.**, Gales, A., Arnulf, I., Oudiette, D., & Paller, K. A. Using real-time reporting to investigate visual experiences in dreams. *Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience*, 38(2), 365–380. <https://doi.org/10.1162/JOCN.a.107> 2026

Morris, D. J., Elliott, D. B., Torres-Platas, S. G., Wall, J., Demšar, E., Konkoly, K. R., Rosman, E., Grabowecky, M., Glowacki, D. R., & Paller, K. A. Lucid dreaming of a prior virtual-reality experience with ego-transcendent qualities: A proof-of-concept study. *Neuroscience of Consciousness*, 2025(1), niaf017. <https://doi.org/10.1093/nc/niaf017> 2025

Konkoly, K. R., **Morris, D. J.**, Cho, M., Hurka, K., Torres-Platas, S. G., Baehr, L., & Paller, K. A. Investigating dreams by strategically presenting sounds during REM sleep to reactivate waking experiences. *Neuropsychologia*, 217, 109229. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.neuropsychologia.2025.109229> 2025

Ellis, B., **Morris, D. J.**, Peterson, A., Marquetti, I., Manietta, L., Borg, M., Halliday, S., Malik, A., Sandbo, N., Gangnon, R., Francois, C. J., & Teodorescu, M. Gastroesophageal reflux, sleep-disordered breathing, and outcomes in patients with idiopathic pulmonary fibrosis. *Canadian Respiratory Journal*, 2025, 4228567. <https://doi.org/10.1155/carj/4228567> 2025

Mundt, J., Pruiskma, K., Konkoly, K., Casiello-Robbins, C., Nadorff, M., Franklin, R., Karanth, S., Byskosh, N., **Morris, D.**, Torres-Platas, G., Mallett, R., Maski, K., & Paller, K. A. Treating narcolepsy-related nightmares with cognitive behavioural therapy and targeted lucidity reactivation: A pilot study. *Journal of Sleep Research*, e14384. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jsr.14384> 2024

Wolk, N., **Morris, D.**, Nahas, Y., Konkoly, K., Carr, M., Paller, K. A., & Mallett, R. Lucid dreams from reactivating mindfulness during REM sleep: A pilot study. *International Journal of Dream Research*, 17(2), 224–227. <https://doi.org/10.11588/ijodr.2024.2.98233> 2024

Konkoly, K. R., Picard-Deland, C., Morris, D. , & Mallett, R. Dreaming outside the box: Evidence for memory abstraction in REM sleep. <i>The Journal of Neuroscience</i> , 43(42), 6952–6953. https://doi.org/10.1523/JNEUROSCI.1374-23.2023	2023
Morris, D. & Baird, B. Lucid dreaming. In J. R. Bertisch (Ed.), <i>Encyclopedia of Sleep and Circadian Rhythms</i> (2nd ed.). Elsevier. https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-12-822963-7.00035-9	2021

Grants and Awards

BrainStorm Neuroscience Pitch \$30,000 Mind Science Foundation <i>Alleviating Nightmares with Lucid-Dreaming Training</i>	2026–2028
Varela Grant \$25,000 Mind & Life Institute <i>Integrating Tibetan Dream Yoga and Western Techniques for Lucid Dream Induction</i>	2025–2027
DreamScience Foundation Grant \$4,000 International Association for the Study of Dreams <i>What factors determine whether sounds are incorporated into dreams? An overnight serial-awakenings study</i>	2023–2024
Summer Internship Funding Grant \$3,000 Middlebury College D Acres of New Hampshire Permaculture Farm and Educational Homestead	2018

Teaching Experience

Brain Damage and the Mind Assistant Instructor, Northwestern University	2024, 2026
Research Methods Assistant Instructor, Northwestern University	2024, 2025
Buddhist Psychology Assistant Instructor, Northwestern University	2023, 2025
ETSI Winter Research Training Program Assistant Instructor	2023, 2024
Statistical Methods in Psychology Assistant Instructor, Northwestern University	2023

Presentations

<i>A dream-engineering database and treatment of trauma-related nightmares.</i> T32 Training Day, Northwestern University.	2026
<i>A laboratory dream-engineering database.</i> Neuroscience of Dreaming Conference, Lucca, Italy.	2026
<i>Targeted lucidity reactivation during sleep for treatment of trauma-related nightmares.</i> Cognitive Neuroscience Brain Mapping Group.	2026
<i>Studying lucid dreaming in collaboration with Tibetan monastic scholars.</i> Psychology 249: Buddhist Psychology, Northwestern University.	2025
<i>Lucid dreaming.</i> Sixth Conference on Ancient and Modern Wisdom, Drepung Gomang Monastery.	2024
<i>What factors determine whether sounds incorporate into dreams?</i> International Association for the Study of Dreams, Kerkrade, Netherlands.	2024
<i>Lucid dreaming.</i> Psychology 249: Buddhist Psychology, Northwestern University.	2023

Selected Published Abstracts

- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., Torres-Platas, S. G., Hirschle, J., Kethamukkala, P., Ericson, E., & Paller, K. A. *A Laboratory Dream-Engineering Database.* Poster presented at the Dream Engineering Conference, Boston, MA. 2026
- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., & Paller, K. A. *When does an external sound become part of a dream? An exploration of EEG predictors, real-time signals, sleep stage, and temporal factors.* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, Boston, MA. 2025
- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., Hurka, K., & Paller, K. A. *Can we experimentally induce a dream of our choosing?* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreams, Kerkrade, Netherlands. 2024
- Morris, D.,** Elliott, B., Torres-Platas, G., Rosman, E., Davis, R., Demšar, E., Wall, J., Glowacki, D., & Paller, K. A. *Can Lucid Dreaming Enhance Compassion and Interconnectedness Following a Buddhist-Inspired VR Experience?* Poster presented at the Mind & Life Summer Research Institute, Garrison, NY. 2024
- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., Hurka, K., & Paller, K. A. *Can we experimentally induce a dream of our choosing?* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, Vancouver, Canada. 2024
- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., & Paller, K. A. *Sensory Disconnection and Lucid Dreams, a Multi-Study Analysis.* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreams, Ashland, OR. 2023
- Morris, D.,** Konkoly, K., Suzuki, S., & Paller, K. A. *Lucid dreamers respond to auditory cues, especially following periods of high EEG theta power.* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, San Francisco, CA. 2023
- Morris, D. & Baird, B.** *Inducing Lucid Dreams with Optimized Sensory Cues.* Poster presented at the International Association for the Study of Dreaming Conference, Tucson, AZ. 2022
- Morris, D.** *The Role of Pulmonary Dysfunction and Sleep Disordered Breathing in the Cardiovascular Dysfunction of Patients with Idiopathic Pulmonary Fibrosis.* Poster presented at the American Thoracic Society Conference, San Francisco, CA. 2021